SMM
Shanghai Metals Market

SMM IRON ORE DAILY

SMM Iron Ore Daily

2026-11-03 Tuesday · Imported & Domestic Ore · Prices · Supply-Demand · Inventory · Commentary

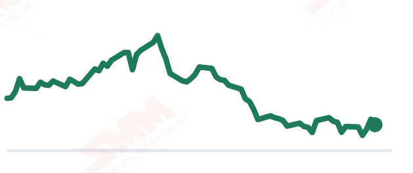
Source SMM / SGX

Futures Contracts

SGX: latest price · DCE: close

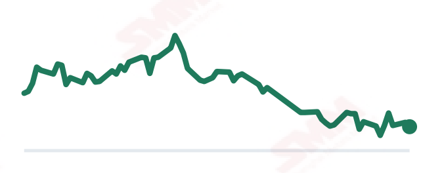
SGX Iron Ore Near-month Contract (2026-11) Latest price

90.85
USD/dmt
FEFX26 · 2026-11 · SGX
As of preparation: 2026-11-03 18:04:12 (UTC+8)
Quote time: 11-03 17:49:40 (UTC+8)


Last 3 months

DCE Iron Ore Most-traded I2701 Daily

671.0
yuan/mt
▼ -3.5 -0.52%
MTD avg 672.8
As of Nov 3 · vs Nov 2

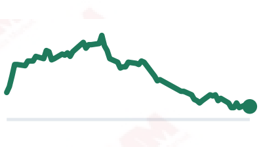

Last 3 months

SMM Iron Ore Price Index

Five MMi indices as of Nov 3

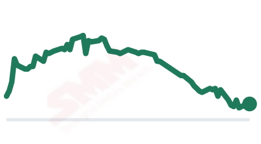
MMi 61% Port Spot Daily

651
yuan/wmt
▼ -2 -0.31%
MTD avg 652


Last 3 months

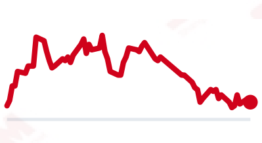
MMi 58% Port Spot Daily

605
yuan/wmt
— 0 0.00%
MTD avg 605


Last 3 months

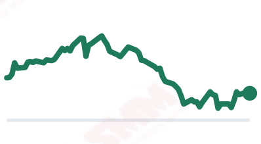
MMi 65% Port Spot Daily

813
yuan/wmt
▼ -2 -0.25%
MTD avg 814


Last 3 months

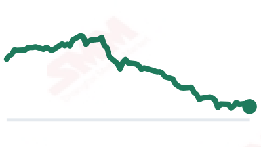
MMi 61% Seaborne Index Daily

90.70
USD/dmt
▼ -0.20 -0.22%
MTD avg 90.80


Last 3 months

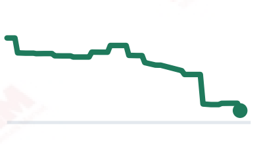
MMi 65% Seaborne Index Daily

106.40
USD/dmt
▼ -0.50 -0.47%
MTD avg 106.65


Last 3 months

SMM Domestic Ore Composite Index Daily

791.29
yuan/mt
▼ -6.15 -0.77%
MTD avg —
As of Oct 30 · vs Oct 29


Last 3 months

Key View

Prices retreat after the month's opening recovery; sustained trading remains key

The previous recovery did not persist, with domestic futures and spot prices retreating today. DCE most-traded closed at 671.0 yuan/mt, down 0.52%. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 651, 605 and 813 yuan/wmt: the low-grade index held steady while the others eased. The seaborne 61% and 65% indices were USD 90.70 and 106.40/dmt, with all 12 brands lower, indicating fragile price support.

Supply flows and baseline consumption offer some cushion. Latest Chinese arrivals fell sharply, ten-port stocks declined and hot metal previously rose modestly. These observations cover different periods and do not by themselves establish stronger demand today. Actual restocking still depends on orders, margins and mill stocks, with transactions needed to confirm the transmission from production to buying.

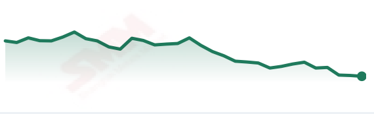
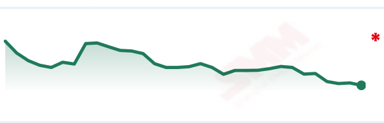
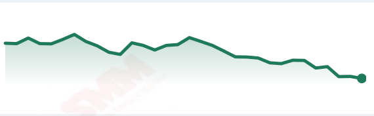
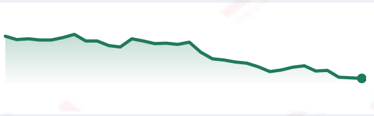
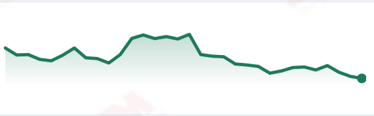
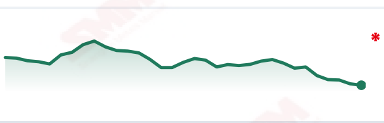
The near-term test is whether price adjustments generate persistent collections. Needs-based buying could leave stocks and profitability constraining upside, while stronger orders alongside margin repair could improve support. Divergent C3 and C5 freight also calls for route-specific cost assessment. A cautious, range-bound view remains appropriate rather than extrapolating a single move into a trend reversal.

Today's Highlights

- **Domestic futures and spot prices retreated.** DCE most-traded I2701 closed at **671.0 yuan/mt**, down 3.5 yuan (-0.52%). Qingdao PB and Newman Fines were both 640 yuan/wmt, down 5 yuan; Mac Fines fell 2 yuan to 648 and Newman Lump fell 10 yuan to 810.
- **Seaborne indices and brand quotations softened.** The 61% index was **USD 90.70/dmt**, down 0.20 (-0.22%), and the 65% was **106.40**, down 0.50 (-0.47%). All 12 brands declined against the Nov 2 report; PB Fines were 91.00, Newman Fines 90.15 and Mac Fines 89.85 USD/dmt.
- **Port indices showed mixed performance.** The 61%, 58% and 65% indices were 651, 605 and 813 yuan/wmt, changing by -2, 0 and -2 yuan. The 65%-58% spread narrowed from 210 to 208 yuan/wmt.
- **Freight costs moved in different directions.** Nov 2 C3 freight was USD 36.72/mt (+1.27%) and C5 was 14.38 (-3.75%). Route-specific changes should be assessed alongside contracts and settlement timing rather than equated directly with current trading margins.

Qingdao Port Imported Ore Spot Prices

yuan/wmt · tax incl.

Product	11-03 (yuan/wmt)	Daily change / %	MTD avg	Last 12 months
PB Fines 60.8% Daily	640	▼ -5 -0.78%	642	
Newman Fines 61.2% Daily	640	▼ -5 -0.78%	642	 *
Mac Fines 60.8% Daily	648	▼ -2 -0.31%	649	
BRBF 62.5% Daily	688	▼ -5 -0.72%	690	
Newman Lump 63% Daily	810	▼ -10 -1.22%	815	
Super Special Fines (SSF) 56.5% Daily	502	▼ -5 -0.99%	504	
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	812	▼ -5 -0.61%	814	
PB Lump 61.5% Daily	810	▼ -5 -0.61%	812	 *

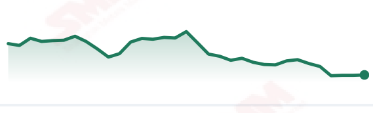
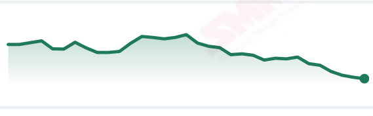
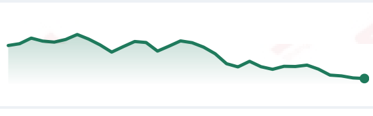
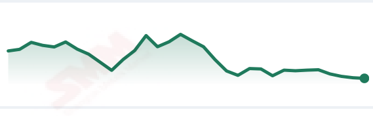
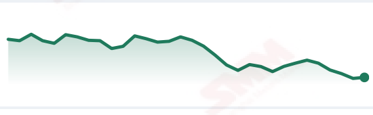
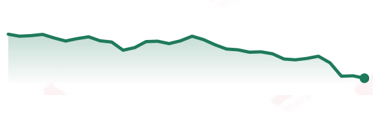
Seaborne Brand Prices in USD & MMi Indices

USD/dmt

Seaborne Brand Prices in USD CFR Qingdao

Product	11-03 (USD/dmt)	Daily change / %	11-02
Roy Hill Fines 62% Daily	87.15	▼ -0.35 -0.40%	87.50
SIMEC Fines 61% Daily	88.00	▼ -0.50 -0.56%	88.50
PB Fines 62% Daily	91.00	▼ -0.20 -0.22%	91.20
Newman Fines 60.7% Daily	90.15	▼ -0.20 -0.22%	90.35
Mac Fines 60.5% Daily	89.85	▼ -0.30 -0.33%	90.15
Jimblebar Fines 60.30% Daily	86.95	▼ -0.40 -0.46%	87.35
Carajas Fines (IOCJ) 65% Daily	106.70	▼ -0.50 -0.47%	107.20
SSFT / SSFG 60% Daily	97.60	▼ -0.60 -0.61%	98.20
Brazilian Blend Fines (BRBF) 64% Daily	97.30	▼ -0.45 -0.46%	97.75
RTX Fines 61% Daily	87.15	▼ -0.20 -0.23%	87.35
West Pilbara Fines (WPF) 60% Daily	89.55	▼ -0.45 -0.50%	90.00
SP10 Fines 59%-60% Daily	79.35	▼ -0.70 -0.87%	80.05

SMM Iron Ore Price Index monthly statistics

Index	Month-to-date avg	MoM	YTD	Unit	Last 12 months
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	90.80	+0.62%	-14.4%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Seaborne Index Daily	106.65	-1.56%	-12.3%	USD/dmt	
SMM MMi 61% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	652	-0.73%	-19.9%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 65% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	814	-0.47%	-9.6%	yuan/wmt	
SMM MMi 58% Iron Ore Port Spot Index Daily	605	-1.51%	-15.7%	yuan/wmt	
SMM China Domestic Ore Composite Price Index Daily	—	—	-10.7%	yuan/mt	

The seaborne 61% index was USD 90.70/dmt (-0.22%) and the 65% was 106.40 (-0.47%), narrowing their spread from USD 16.00 to 15.70/dmt. The 61%, 58% and 65% port indices were 651, 605 and 813 yuan/wmt, changing by -2, 0 and -2 yuan.

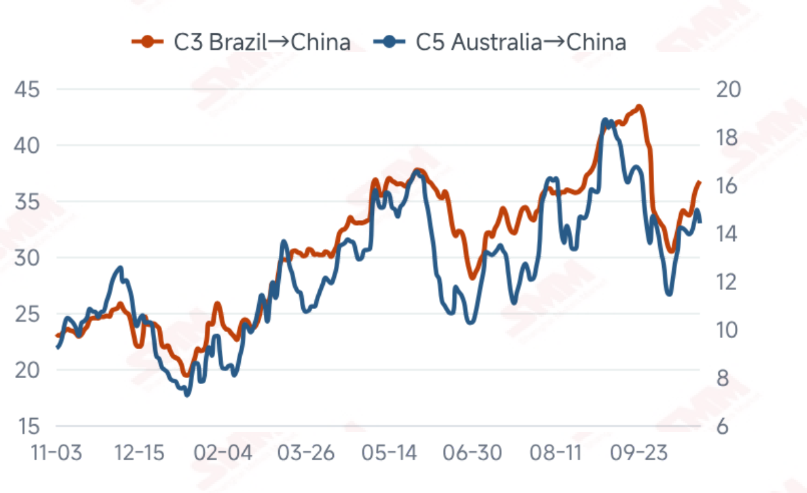
* SMM yuan quotations for Newman Fines and PB Lump start in Mar 2026; their sparklines cover that shorter window only. All others show the past year.

Key Price Drivers

Last 12 months

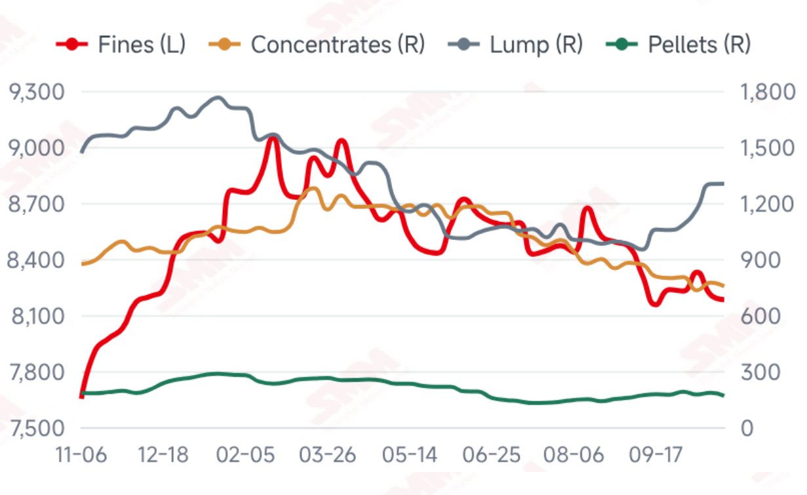
Iron Ore Ocean Freight

USD/mt · daily · last 12M · C3 Tubarão→Beilun/Baoshan, C5 W. Australia Dampier→Qingdao/Beilun/Baoshan



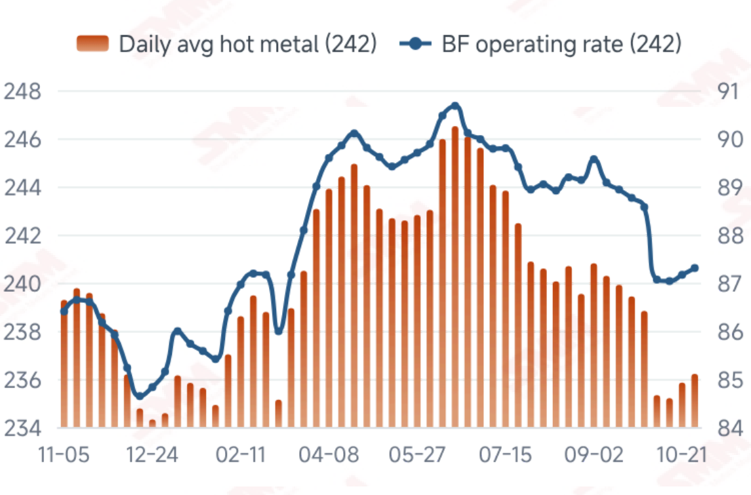
Iron Ore Port Inventory at 10 Ports · by Product

Left: fines Right: concentrates / lump / pellets · 10,000 mt · weekly



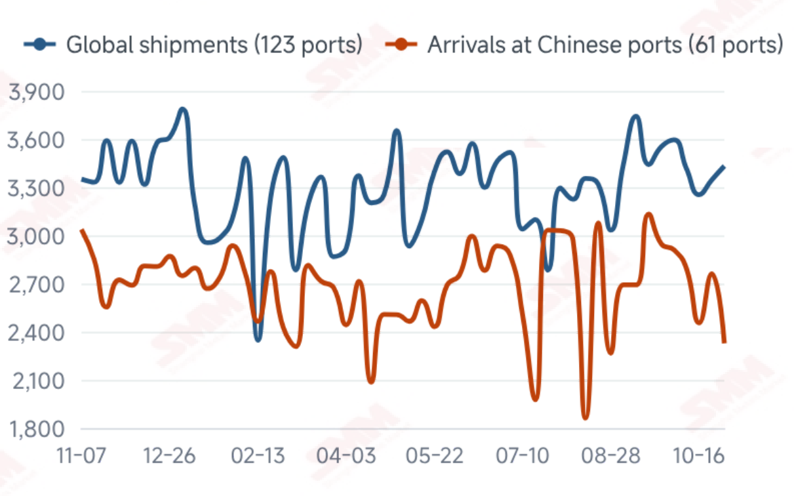
Daily Avg Hot Metal Output & BF Operating Rate, 242 Mills

Left: 10,000 mt Right: % · weekly



Global Iron Ore Shipments vs Arrivals at Chinese Ports

10,000 mt · weekly · shipments 123 ports / arrivals 61 ports



Market Commentary · Imported Ore

Futures & spot	DCE most-traded I2701 closed at 671.0 yuan/mt, down 0.52% from Nov 2. Qingdao PB Fines were 640, Newman Fines 640, BRBF 688, SSF 502, Carajas Fines 812 and PB Lump 810 yuan/wmt, each down 5 yuan; Mac Fines were 648 (-2) and Newman Lump 810 (-10). SGX official near-month FEFX26 (November 2026) was last priced at USD 90.85/dmt, timestamped Nov 3, 17:49:40 (UTC+8). SMM's daily review reported needs-based mill buying and moderate overall transactions.
Drivers	Futures and most spot quotations pulled back after the month's opening recovery, leaving the rebound dependent on persistent transactions. The seaborne 65% index fell more than the 61%, narrowing their spread from USD 16.00 to 15.70/dmt. Resource composition and buying schedules may influence relative pricing, but one session is insufficient to establish a lasting change in demand preferences.
Demand	The latest 242-mill survey showed daily hot metal output of 2.3621 million mt on Oct 28, up 3,700 mt, with a blast furnace operating rate of 87.30%. Whether stronger baseline consumption generates discretionary restocking depends on mill stocks, finished-steel orders and margins. Environmental restrictions and maintenance may affect subsequent production, leaving actual transactions important to assessing buying intensity. SMM's Nov 3 review cited projected blast furnace maintenance losses of 1.6983 million mt for Oct 31–Nov 6, down 57,900 mt from the preceding week. This is a whole-week maintenance estimate, not daily hot metal or realised additional output.
Inventory & supply	Global shipments were 34.3119 million mt in the week to Oct 30, up 2.58% WoW, while arrivals in China fell 15.73% to 23.2663 million mt. The latest ten-port inventory was 104.0353 million mt on Oct 29, down 618,100 mt from Oct 22. Lower arrivals ease near-term incoming pressure, but stock absorption also depends on unloading and mill collections rather than one flow measure establishing broad supply tightness.
Cost & margin	Nov 2 freight was USD 36.72/mt for C3, up 0.46 (+1.27%), and 14.38 for C5, down 0.56 (-3.75%). Lower port selling prices may squeeze some trading returns while transport costs diverge across routes. Contracts, exchange rates and settlement periods determine actual margins; import trading profitability should not be equated with steelmaking or coking earnings. SMM's assessment published on the morning of Nov 3 put the period's average import margin at 2.19 yuan/mt, up 2.15 yuan from 0.04; this import trading measure should not be treated as post-close mill profitability for the current session.

Market Commentary · Domestic Ore

Prices	The latest Domestic Ore Composite Price Index was 791.29 yuan/mt on Oct 30. SMM's Nov 2 Shandong brief quoted 64% basic concentrate at 754 yuan/mt, down 3 yuan, on a dry-basis, pre-tax ex-mine quotation payable by acceptance bill. Grade and pricing terms distinguish this regional quotation from the national index.
Supply & demand	SMM described mostly normal mine operations and good sales in Shandong, improved relative value for domestic concentrates and comparatively active mill purchases. These regional observations do not establish a nationwide demand recovery; resources, contracts and actual collections should be tracked separately.
Outlook	SMM expects Shandong concentrate prices to remain range-bound near term. Persistent regional buying improvement could support prices, while continued pressure on mill margins could limit upside.

Market Factors

▲ Supportive factors

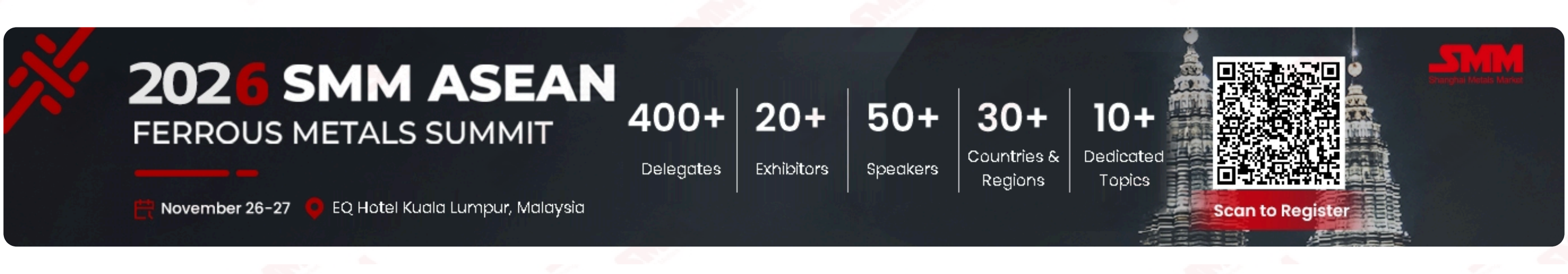
- Latest arrivals in China fell 15.73% WoW.
- The latest hot metal reading increased 3,700 mt WoW.
- Latest ten-port stocks fell 618,100 mt from the preceding survey.
- Lower C5 freight reduced transport costs for some cargoes.

▼ Bearish factors

- DCE fell 0.52% and all eight port products declined.
- Both seaborne indices and all 12 brand quotations weakened.
- Sustained restocking remains constrained by orders, margins and stock management.
- Higher C3 freight may increase costs on some routes.

Flash News

- [SMM Iron Ore] Iron ore futures, spot ease as maintenance cut offers limited support
  2026-11-03 ↗
- [SMM Coking Coal and Coke Daily Brief] 20261103
  2026-11-03 ↗
- [ArcelorMittal Advances Liberia Iron Ore Expansion with Country's First Concentrator]
  2026-11-03 ↗
- [SMM Steel] Vietnam HRC Import Prices Edge Higher as Domestic Offers Exceed Indonesian Cargoes
  2026-11-03 ↗
- [SMM Steel] India Domestic Steel Prices Soften on Weak Demand
  2026-11-03 ↗
- [SMM Steel] Indian Steel Prices Hold Steady Amid Slow Export Buying
  2026-11-03 ↗



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